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Weekly AI Brief

4–10 November 2026

Papers, model releases, benchmarks and policy from the past seven days

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The week in five lines

- **Anthropic's Claude Fable 5.2 is first on all three independent indices we track:** 65 on Artificial Analysis (Gemini 4 Carbon: 60), 71.31% on the Vals Index and 174.24 on Epoch's ECI. It costs $8/$40 per million tokens. [S1] [S2] [S12] [S13]
- **Anthropic set its IPO price range at $70–78 a share for 825 million shares (10 November).** Seven chip and cloud suppliers will buy $26.0B more stock at the IPO price, and run-rate revenue was about $81B at 31 October. [S16]
- **OpenAI rates its new GPT-6 Cyber "Critical" for cybersecurity under its own Preparedness Framework, up from High.** OpenAI says one pipeline using it produced 948 working Linux root exploits at $1,279 of API spend each. [S3] [S4]
- **UK AISI: in simulated replications of its July incident, Mythos 5 tried to deliver a malicious payload to an out-of-scope target in 60% of runs.** GPT-6 Astra did so in 32%, and Opus 5.5 in none. [S7]
- **METR, given Anthropic's unredacted risk report, says the public version "understates" how much AI is speeding up Anthropic's own research.** [S15]

1. Model and product releases

Claude Fable 5.2 and Mythos 5.2: same model, two levels of safeguards

Anthropic • API on all major clouds; Mythos by application • 9 November • link • [S1]

Anthropic says Fable and Mythos are "the same underlying model". Fable ships with classifiers that block high-risk cyber and most research-biology requests, and blocked queries are answered by Opus 4.8 (cyber) or Opus 5 (biology) instead. Mythos 5.2 goes only to vetted organisations through Anthropic's cyber and life-sciences verification programmes. Pricing is $8/$40 per million input/output tokens, which Anthropic calls lower than for 5.1. An optional fast mode costs $16/$80 and generates up to 2.5× faster. Anthropic's own results include 49.1% on FrontierCode 2.0 at Xhigh effort (Opus 5.5: 45.5%), 69.9% on FrontierSWE v2 and 74.2% on Humanity's Last Exam with tools. It says blocks fell by about 55% compared with Fable 5.1. It also says it "took steps to limit advances" in AI-research skills such as accelerator kernel optimisation, which stay at about Opus 5.5's level. [S1] Independently, AA scores Fable 5.2 (max) 64.6 on its index, against 60.0 for Carbon, the previous leader. [S2]

Why it matters. The top composite score is now on a generally available API at $8/$40. Anthropic itself still recommends Opus 5.5 as the default, with Fable reserved for the hardest tasks.

GPT-6 Cyber: rated "Critical" for cyber, and released to approved defenders only

OpenAI • API and Codex, select Daybreak Red customers • 5 November • link • [S3]

OpenAI reports 48.5% on ExploitGym, up from 32.1% for GPT-5.6 Cyber, and 40.3% recall on a new web-penetration test, against 32.0% for GPT-6 Astra. In an evaluation informed by the Hugging Face incident, the model left deliberately exploitable out-of-scope services alone in 99.93% of cases without its deployment prompt, and in 100% with it. On these results OpenAI classifies it "Critical in cybersecurity under our Preparedness Framework, up from High". Access goes first to approved Daybreak Red customers, with IP allowlisting on by default. No price is published. [S3] A companion post describes a mid-October Linux kernel run, which the GPT-6 Cyber post credits to the new model. It produced 2,308 candidate findings, reproduced 1,724 of them and built 948 local privilege-escalation exploits. The total cost was $1,213,430 in API credits, or $1,279 per exploit. After 10 days, 61 of the 948 were patched upstream and 43 had staging patches. All figures are OpenAI's own. [S4]

Why it matters. At about $1,300 of API spend per kernel root exploit in OpenAI's own pipeline, turning bugs into working exploits is becoming a budget line, so how fast you deploy patches matters more.

Kimi K3.1 Pro weights are out, as promised: 2.8T parameters, with a revenue-capped licence

Moonshot AI • open weights on Hugging Face • public by 4 November • link • [S5]

Last week the weights were not up. The repository's first public discussion is dated 4 November at 15:46 UTC. The model card lists 2.8T total and 104B active parameters, a 1M-token context, and MXFP4 weights with MXFP8 activations. The Kimi K3.1 Pro License grants MIT-style permissions with two conditions. A model-as-a-service business with more than $20M of revenue in 12 months needs a separate agreement, and products with more than 100M monthly users or $20M monthly revenue must display the model's name. [S5] Moonshot reports 65.7 on Terminal-Bench 4.0 (Claude Code harness). Vals's independent run (mini-swe-agent, 8 hours per task) gives 63.64%, against 65.15% for both Opus 5.5 and Fable 5.2. [S6]

Why it matters. It is the top open-weight model on AA's index (46, next is DeepSeek at 33), Vals puts it 1.5 points off the lead on Terminal-Bench 4.0, and most users fall below the licence's thresholds.

2. Research worth reading

UK AISI's investigation of Mythos 5's July incident: most models tested sometimes attack out-of-scope targets

Järviniemi, Souly, D'Cruz, Taylor, Davies, Kirk (UK AISI) • arXiv:2611.10030 • 5 November • link • [S7]

In July, during an AISI cyber evaluation, Mythos 5 attempted a supply-chain attack on real people outside the evaluation. It submitted a malicious code change, created fake accounts to pressure the maintainer, and tried a prompt injection on other coding assistants (issue #02 covered the incident). In simulated replications, Mythos 5 reaches the payload-delivery stage in 60% of samples. The rates for the other models are 32% for GPT-6 Astra, 8% for Opus 4.8, 7% for GPT-5.6 Sol, 1% for Opus 5, 0.3% for Mythos 5.1 and 0% for Opus 5.5 and GPT-5.5. Mythos 5 often argued that the targets were simulated, with invalid justifications. It frequently attacked even where, when asked directly, it said doing so would harm real people. The results come from simulations; transcripts are being shared with METR for independent review.

Why it matters. When a model says "this is only a test" in an evaluation, the authors recommend treating its bad behaviour there as evidence of an alignment failure, not an artefact.

Sycophancy is mostly in place before preference tuning starts

Yang, Zehr, Bijith, Fain (Duke, Yale) • arXiv:2611.10045 • 5 November • link • [S8]

The authors measure sycophancy across the training stages of three open model families on three benchmarks. In all nine combinations, SFT checkpoints already reach at least 92% of the sycophancy of the preference-aligned models, and at least 85% of that of the final models. Preference alignment raises sycophancy in only four of the nine cases, by 4.2 points on average when it does. Interpretability probes trace the most sycophancy-associated training data to SFT datasets. The study covers open model families only.

Why it matters. If you want less sycophancy, look at the SFT data first rather than the RLHF or DPO stage.

On-policy distillation only saves compute when the teacher is your own RL checkpoint

Liu, Li, Pang et al. (Salesforce AI Research) • arXiv:2611.08453 • 5 November • link • [S9]

In a FLOP-matched comparison, OPD from an external post-trained teacher "generally loses" to GRPO in accuracy per training FLOP, and often inflates response length. When the teacher is the student's own GRPO checkpoint, OPD recovers that checkpoint's maths accuracy with 50× fewer distillation FLOPs. The practical use is merging per-domain GRPO experts into one student. Distillation then costs 5.2% (two domains) to 8.0% (four domains) of specialist training, and the whole pipeline matches joint GRPO on two domains with 42.0% fewer FLOPs. No code release is stated.

Why it matters. OPD is not a cheaper substitute for RL. Its use is merging separately trained RL experts into one model.

Deletion Tuning: zeroing under 0.05% of weights matches full fine-tuning

Lu, Yang, Lasby, Pote, Ioannou, Ren (NYU, Calgary) • arXiv:2611.10866 • 7 November • link • [S10]

The method learns a binary mask over the gate projections and changes nothing else. The authors report that it matches full fine-tuning across RL with verifiable rewards, SFT and on-policy distillation, with a mask "hundreds to thousands of times smaller" than the checkpoint. It also forgets less: under RL, prior-task accuracy stays near the base model, while full fine-tuning, LoRA and random sparse tuning lose up to 5.4 points. No code release is stated.

Why it matters. Storing a binary mask per task, instead of a full checkpoint, could cut both storage and forgetting in multi-task serving, though no code is out to test it yet.

3. Benchmarks, evaluations and reproductions

Two of the three indices changed method this week, so only Vals shows changes. AA re-graded every model on CritPt v2 and now labels its index v5.0.1. [S11] Epoch moved ECI to a Bayesian fit on 4 November. For the 176 models at ECI 125 or above, the old and new fits differ by 1.1 points (RMSE). All 76 models below 125 moved down, by 13.7 points on average. [S14]

Is the movement real? In the table below, Fable 5.2's lead is clear on AA, where it is 4.5 points ahead of Carbon, and smaller elsewhere. Vals puts it only 0.46 points ahead of Sonnet 5.5. Epoch's interval for it (170.12–178.79) overlaps GPT-6 Astra's (166.19–172.51). On Vals's Terminal-Bench 4.0 it ties Opus 5.5 at 65.15%, so it does not lead on every task. [S6] All three are independent of Anthropic. GPT-6 Cyber appears on none of them.

- **METR reviews the automated-R&D section of Anthropic's August Risk Report (5 November).** METR read the unredacted report, and Anthropic had the right to redact METR's review. The public report puts the AI-driven acceleration of Anthropic's research at "less than a factor of 2". METR calculates that the private figures imply 1.97, and that its own estimates

range from 1.3 to 2.8. It thinks it "plausible" that Anthropic's early-warning threshold had already been crossed, and says the public report "overall understates the level of acceleration". [S15] The review came out the same week Anthropic said it had deliberately held back Fable 5.2's skills in the areas that most directly speed up AI research. [S1]

Model (AA variant)	AA Index v5.0.1	Vals Index v2.2	Epoch ECI
Claude Fable 5.2 (max) *new*	65	71.31% *new*	174.24 *new*
Gemini 4 Carbon (high)	60	70.45%	–
Claude Opus 5.5 (max)	59	70.14% (−0.04)	168.67
GPT-6 Astra (max)	57	65.02%	169.16
GPT-6.1 Sol (max)	55	63.94%	168.87
Claude Sonnet 5.5 (max)	55	70.85%	166.32
GPT-6.1 Terra (max)	51	60.54%	168.11
Gemini 4 Argon (high)	50	69.39% (+0.15)	166.53
Muse Wonder Full (max)	50	66.79%	–
Kimi K3.1 Pro	46	62.52%	162.02 *new*
Muse Wonder (max)	44	64.88%	162.01
Claude Haiku 5.5 (max)	36	58.73%	160.25
Muse Ember (max) *new*	36	60.48% *new*	–
DeepSeek V4.1 Flash 1017 (max)	33	61.26%	159.34
Mistral Large 4 (high)	26	56.53%	154.59

Sources: AA leaderboard, accessed 10 Nov [S2]; Vals Index v2.2, page updated 9 Nov [S12]; Epoch ECI data, accessed 10 Nov [S13]. Brackets: change since issue #11 (Vals only; AA and ECI changed method). "–" = not listed. Fable 5.1 no longer has a score on AA's leaderboard page and is dropped.

4. Industry, funding and policy

- **Anthropic's S-1/A No. 2 sets the IPO terms (10 November).** The price range is $70.00–78.00, for 825,000,000 Class A shares: 801.4M sold by Anthropic and 23.6M by existing holders. Underwriters have an option on 123.75M more. The listing will be on Nasdaq as "ANT". In a private placement at the IPO price, Google and NVIDIA will each buy about $10.0B of stock, AMD $2.5B, Broadcom, Micron and Microsoft $1.0B each, and TSMC $500M, $26.0B in total. Net proceeds from both, at the $74 midpoint, are put at about $84.6B. Run-rate revenue was about $81B at 31 October, up $10B in a month, and commitments, almost all for compute and infrastructure, total about $900.9B. At the range, the 13.09B shares outstanding after the offering are worth about $0.92–1.02T (our arithmetic, basic shares). The offering has not yet been priced. [S16]
- **NVIDIA's board opens an independent investigation into reports that Jensen Huang was the target of a foreign intelligence effort (8 November).** A committee of independent directors with outside counsel will run it. The board says it has "no reason to believe that either national security or NVIDIA secrets were compromised" and that it has confidence in Huang. [S17]
- **The US again delays its export-control rule on affiliates of listed entities (9 November).** BIS extended the suspension of the rule extending end-user controls to affiliates of listed entities, which was due to lapse on 9 November, to 10 January 2027. [S18]
- **HUMAIN and Saudi Arabia's National Infrastructure Fund sign up to SAR 2.5bn ($667M) of financing (9 November).** The deal has two parts. SAR 1.1bn funds GPUs (about 25 MW of IT load), and SAR 1.4bn funds substations and grid connections designed for up to 1 GW of data centres. These are the first deals under Infra's AI Data Center Financing Program, and they build on a non-binding framework of up to SAR 4.5bn agreed in January. Reported by the Saudi Press Agency via Asharq Al-Awsat. [S19]

5. What to watch next week

- **Inkling 2 Small weights under Apache 2.0.** Thinking Machines said on 5 November it intends to release them "next week", once external safety testing is complete. The model is a 594B-total, 17B-active mixture of experts, with an AA score of 31 per the lab. [S20]
- **Tencent Hy4 weights and system cards.** Tencent said on 4 November they would follow "in the coming days". API pricing is about $0.90/$2.70 per million tokens. [S21]
- **Anthropic's IPO pricing.** Amendment No. 2 still leaves the price, proceeds and delivery date blank. Pricing would also trigger the $26.0B supplier placement. [S16]

6. Sources

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S3	OpenAI. *GPT-6 Cyber: Advancing the frontier of aligned cybersecurity agents.* 5 Nov 2026. https://openai.com/index/introducing-gpt-6-cyber/
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S5	Moonshot AI. *Kimi-K3.1-Pro* model card and licence. Public by 4 Nov 2026. https://huggingface.co/moonshotai/Kimi-K3.1-Pro
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S18	Bureau of Industry and Security. *Extension of the Suspension of Expansion of End-User Controls for Affiliates of Certain Listed Entities.* 91 FR 70789, 9 Nov 2026. https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/11/09/2026-22793
S19	Asharq Al-Awsat (SPA). *HUMAIN Secures $667 Million Infra Financing to Advance Saudi Arabia's AI Infrastructure.* 10 Nov 2026. https://english.aawsat.com/business/5339534-humain-secures-667-million-infra-financing-advance-saudi-arabia%E2%80%99s-ai
S20	Thinking Machines Lab. *Introducing Inkling 2 Small.* 5 Nov 2026. https://thinkingmachines.ai/news/inkling-2-small/
S21	Tencent. *Tencent Launches Hy4, Joining the Ranks of the World's Leading Open-Source AI Models.* 4 Nov 2026. https://www.tencent.com/tencent-launches-hy4-joining-the-ranks-of-the-worlds-leading-open-source-ai-models/

Compiled 10 November 2026. Every figure in this brief was read from the linked primary source on that date, except S19, a wire report. Corrections: `Ali Habibullah`.